

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

INDIA – EU – 02

MODULE – 49

INDIA AND EUROPEAN UNION (EU)

- 1 India was among the first countries to establish diplomatic relations with the European Economic Community.
- 2 The European Union and India have celebrated several important anniversaries - 50 years since the establishment of diplomatic relations in 1962, 30 years since the opening of the EU Delegation in New Delhi in 1983, and 10 years of the EU-India Strategic Partnership launched in 2004.
- 3 India and EU are separated widely by geography as well as history, but there are a lot of similarities between them

- 4 They have both gone through a unique process of institution building to balance the rights of their citizens with the need for cohesion;



INDIA AND EUROPEAN UNION (EU)

5 They represent the two largest democracies in the world; culturally and linguistically diverse, they are also among the most diverse regions on the planet; and actually they both have 28 member states.

6 Relations once focused on trade and development have become more political, security, environment, science and technology-oriented, reflecting mutual interests in the globalised world.



FACTORS SHAPING INDIA-EU RELATIONS IN THE CURRENT TIMES

- 1 Changing Geopolitical developments:** EU sees EU-India relations in the context of broader geopolitical developments, primarily the rise of China.
- 2 Impact of China in Europe and Asia** (e.g. Belt and Road initiative) has pushed EU to change the nature of its partnerships in the region, particularly with India.
- 3 Convergence of interests in the Indian Ocean:** Increasing Naval base race and security competition in the Indian Ocean region will impact both Europe and India as the Indian Ocean is the main conduit for global trade and energy flows.



FACTORS SHAPING INDIA-EU RELATIONS IN THE CURRENT TIMES

4 India, EU see each other as partners in securing the Indian Ocean by strengthening institutions, rule of law, and a regional security architecture.

5 Retreat of the U.S. from global leadership and uncertainty of US policy under Trump has provided opportunities for EU- India cooperation and trilateral dialogues with countries in the Middle East, Central Asia and Africa.

6 Strategic rivalry between the US and China: Both EU and India have a common interest in avoiding a bipolarized world and sustaining a rules-based multilateral trading system with the United Nations and the World Trade Organization at its core Green governance.



FACTORS SHAPING INDIA-EU RELATIONS IN THE CURRENT TIMES

7 After the US exit from the Paris climate agreement, India and the EU stand to gain from a joint leadership on global governance matters such as climate change, clean energy or circular economy.

8 New emerging world order after COVID-19: As EU seeks to move away from a global supply chain dependent on China, India can emerge as its most natural ally. EU and India could find a common path in ensuring supply chain resilience to reform the global system in response to health emergencies



POLITICAL

- 1** In 1994, a cooperation agreement was signed between India and EU which took the bilateral relationship beyond trade and economic cooperation.
- 2** At the 5th India-EU Summit at The Hague in 2004, the relationship was upgraded to a 'Strategic Partnership'.
- 3** The two sides adopted a Joint Action Plan in 2005 that provided for strengthening dialogue and consultation mechanisms in the political and economic spheres, enhancing trade and investment, and bringing peoples and cultures together.

- 4** A Delegation for Relations with India (D-IN) was formally constituted in the European Parliament (EP) in 2007. It has 28 regular and 22 substitute members who are drawn from various political groups in accordance with their numerical strength in the EP.



INDIA-EU SUMMIT

- The first India-EU Summit took place in Lisbon in June 2000.
- The 15th Summit between India and the European Union (EU) was held in virtual format on 15th July 2020.

POLITICAL

- 1 The leaders decided to strengthen the EU-India Strategic Partnership, based on shared principles and values of democracy, freedom, rule of law, and respect for human rights.
- 2 As the world's two largest democracies India and EU agreed to strive to promote multilateralism and a rules-based multilateral order with the United Nations (UN) and the World Trade Organisation (WTO)

- 3 The EU is looking forward to India's G20 Presidency in 2022 and its membership in the UN Security Council in 2021-2022
- 4 The leaders agreed that global cooperation and solidarity were essential to protect lives and to mitigate the socio-economic consequences of the coronavirus pandemic



INDIA-EU SUMMIT

ECONOMIC

- 1 Agreed to establish regular High-Level Dialogue to guide negotiations on Broad based Trade and Investment Agreement (BTIA) and to address multilateral issues of mutual interest.
- 2 The EU and India agreed to keep the global trading system open, with the WTO as the bedrock of the rules-based multilateral trading system
- 3 The leaders welcomed the G20 Action Plan to support the global economy and underlined the need to assist the most vulnerable countries.
- 4 The EU and India agreed to enhance coordination on global economic governance particularly in the framework of the G20. They would continue working together to promote debt sustainability, including in the G20.

India now has a trade deficit with EU

	(In \$Bn)		CHANGE
Exports	2017-18	53.6	6.7%
	2018-19	57.2	
Imports	2017-18	47.9	21.9%
	2018-19	58.4	
Trade Balance	2017-18	5.7	
	2018-19	-1.2	

Negative trade balance indicates deficit
Source: Commerce dept

INDIA-EU SUMMIT

PEACE AND SECURITY

- 1 India and EU reaffirmed their strong commitment to global peace and security, disarmament and non-proliferation and to combat terrorism in all its forms and manifestations, including its financing and countering radicalization.
- 2 The EU and India will continue to cooperate on international and regional issues of common interest including Iran and Afghanistan.



INDIA-EU SUMMIT

PEACE AND SECURITY

- 3 Agreement between India-EURATOM (European Atomic Energy Community) on research and development cooperation in the peaceful uses of nuclear energy was signed.
- 4 EU and India have instituted several mechanisms for greater cooperation on pressing security challenges like counter-terrorism, maritime security, and nuclear non-proliferation.
- 5 Information Fusion Centre – Indian Ocean Region in New Delhi (IFC-IOR) has recently been linked-up with the Maritime Security Centre – Horn of Africa (MSC-HOA) established by the EU Naval Force (NAVFOR).



INDIA-EU SUMMIT

CLIMATE CHANGE

1 The leaders reaffirmed their commitment to the implementation of the Paris Agreement including with regard to nationally determined contributions in line with this agreement.

2 Resolute and coordinated action is key to tackle the generational challenge of climate change and environmental degradation.

3 The Leaders welcomed the ongoing cooperation between the EU and India under the Clean Energy and Climate Partnership.



INDIA-EU SUMMIT

CLIMATE CHANGE

4 The EU and India will reinforce their cooperation in the International Solar Alliance (ISA) to promote the deployment of solar energy, and in the International Platform on Sustainable Finance (IPSF) to mobilise private capital towards environmentally sustainable investments.

5 The EU looks forward to cooperating with the Coalition for Disaster Resilient Infrastructure (CDRI) launched by India to ensure that infrastructures are resilient to climate change.

6 They also agreed to work closely together in developing an ambitious post-2020 global framework to protect biodiversity, to be adopted at the 2021 UN Biodiversity Conference.



**INDIA-EU WATER
PARTNERSHIP**

INDIA-EU SUMMIT

CLEAN ENERGY

- 1** India and EU agreed to boost cooperation to support clean energy transition, resource efficiency and circular economy, and the necessary technological leaps, while opening new business opportunities.
- 2** The EU and India will further develop cooperation on smart and sustainable urbanisation
- 3** India and the EU set up an Energy Panel in 2005 for cooperation in energy and energy security and both cooperate on forums such as EU-India Clean Energy Cooperation and India-EU Water Partnership.



INDIA-EU SUMMIT

CYBER SECURITY

1 India and EU agreed to enhance convergences between their regulatory frameworks to ensure a high level of protection of personal data and privacy, including through possible data adequacy decisions, with a view to facilitating safe and secure cross border data flows between them.

2 The EU and India will upgrade their dialogue and cooperation on technology.

3 They will engage on 5G and Artificial Intelligence including to promote global standards and to foster their safe and ethical deployment.



INDIA-EU SUMMIT

RESEARCH & DEVELOPMENT

- 1** The leaders adopted a **Joint Declaration on Resource Efficiency and Circular Economy** and welcomed the upcoming renewal of the EU-India Science and Technology Agreement for another five years.
- 2** They agreed to reconvene for the **16th India-EU Summit in 2021**.
- 3** EU is supporting the **Mobilize Your City (MYC) programme** in India currently in three pilot cities to reduce their urban transport-related Green House Gas (GHG) emissions.

*India and EU adopted the “**EU-India Strategic Partnership: A Roadmap to 2025**” to guide cooperation between the EU and India over the next five years.*



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